

Single Source Justification (Simplified Acquisition)

Section A: General Contract Information

Is this a Bridge Action as defined in the [AF Bridge Action Reduction Plan](#)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Contracting Activity: OL:/PZIMB

Project/Program Name: Zeiss AxioObserver 7 Mat

Purchase Request / Local ID Number: 15885

Estimated Contract Cost (including Options): \$94,254.49

Section B: Description of the Supplies/Services Required

This acquisition is for one (1) new Zeiss Axio Observer 7 MAT Metallograph system. This is a brand name requirement essential to the mission.

Section C: Justification for Soliciting from a Single Source or Brand Name

The requested Zeiss Axio Observer 7 MAT Metallograph must be an identical model to the existing Zeiss metallograph currently owned and operated by the Government. This is required to ensure seamless operational continuity, data compatibility, and workflow uniformity between the new and existing units. The new metallograph must fully integrate with the current laboratory setup, which includes Zeiss-specific Zen core software, programmable motorized stages, and various analytical modules.

Acquiring the same brand and model will allow personnel to use both systems interchangeably without the need for additional, duplicative training on a different platform. Furthermore, it will prevent the introduction of inefficient and complex data conversion process that would be necessary if a different manufacturer's system were acquired. This standardization is critical for maintaining data integrity and operation efficiency.

Section D: Efforts to Obtain Competition

Market research identified three (3) distributors of the Zeiss Axio Observer 7 MAT Metallograph.

Bartels & Stout Inc.
Cage Code 2Y778
Small Business
157th Ave SE
Bellevue, Washington 98008

Carl Zeiss Industrial Quality Solutions LLC.
Cage Code 9DRR4
Large Business
6250 Sycamore Ln N
Maple Grove, Minnesota 55369

Allied High Tech Products Inc.
Cage Code 0WVC6
Small Business

Single Source Justification (Simplified Acquisition)

Carmenita Rd
Cerritos, California 90703

Section E: Steps to Preclude Future Single Source or Brand Name Awards

The government will continue to monitor the industry and proactively conduct market research ensuring future procurements are competitive.

Section F: Contracting Officer's Determination

I have determined, in accordance with [FAR 13.106-1\(b\)\(1\)](#), that the circumstances of this contract action deem only a single source is reasonably available.

Date	Typed Name and Rank/Grade of Contracting Officer	Signature of Contracting Officer
23-Apr-2026	Hideo Mera/ NH-03	